🪖 Day 2: America Joins the War: Daily Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 7 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · World War I

Name: _____

🎯 *Today: The events that brought the United States into the war in 1917.*

🔁 Warm-up (5-minute review)

1. What year did the United States join World War I?
1917

Key terms: 1917 · Lusitania · Mexico · unrestricted submarine warfare · Zimmermann

📝 Guided notes

1. In 1915 a German U-boat sank the **Lusitania**. 128 Americans died.
2. Germany used **unrestricted submarine warfare**: U-boats sank ships without warning.
3. The **Zimmermann** telegram (1917) was a secret German message to Mexico.
4. Germany promised to help **Mexico** get back Texas, New Mexico and Arizona.
5. In April **1917**, Congress declared war on Germany.
6. President **Wilson** said the world must be “made safe for democracy.”
7. The British decoded the telegram and gave it to the U.S.; it made many Americans **angry**.

✍️ Analyze

1. Which reason for joining the war do you think mattered most? Why?
Any reason with support: U-boat attacks killed Americans; the Zimmermann telegram threatened U.S. land; ties to Britain and France.

🎟️ Exit ticket

1. The Zimmermann telegram asked Mexico to…

A. play a game	B. build a railroad	**C. join Germany against the U.S.**

2. What did the Zimmermann telegram propose if the U.S. went to war with Germany?
Mexico would attack the U.S.; Germany would help Mexico win back Texas, New Mexico and Arizona.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*